



Dealing with exhaustion There may be times when you feel too exhausted to move, but try to eat for energy and stay hydrated.

TOP TIPS

Having a glass of freshly squeezed orange juice or eating other vitamin-C rich foods at the same time as eating iron-rich foods will help iron absorption.

Start your day with a bowl of oatmeal topped with a handful of berries, such as blueberries or raspberries; or with two slices of whole-wheat toast topped with a poached egg to keep you going through the morning.

Aim to have protein at breakfast and lunch, so that you feel the energy benefits during the day when you need them the most.

so take it as a sign to drink a glass of water immediately. Another sign of whether you are dehydrated or not is the color of your urine: the paler it is (ideally pale or straw-colored), the better hydrated you are. If your urine is dark, drink more water. Get into good habits to help stay hydrated: carry a water bottle with you and sip it little and often; put a glass of water beside you whenever you sit down; and drink a glass of water each time you go into the kitchen. Remember that milk, juices, and fruit teas (see p.53) count toward your daily intake, but caffeine and carbonated drinks don't.

Q I'm starving all the time—is it okay to eat more than I did before I became pregnant?

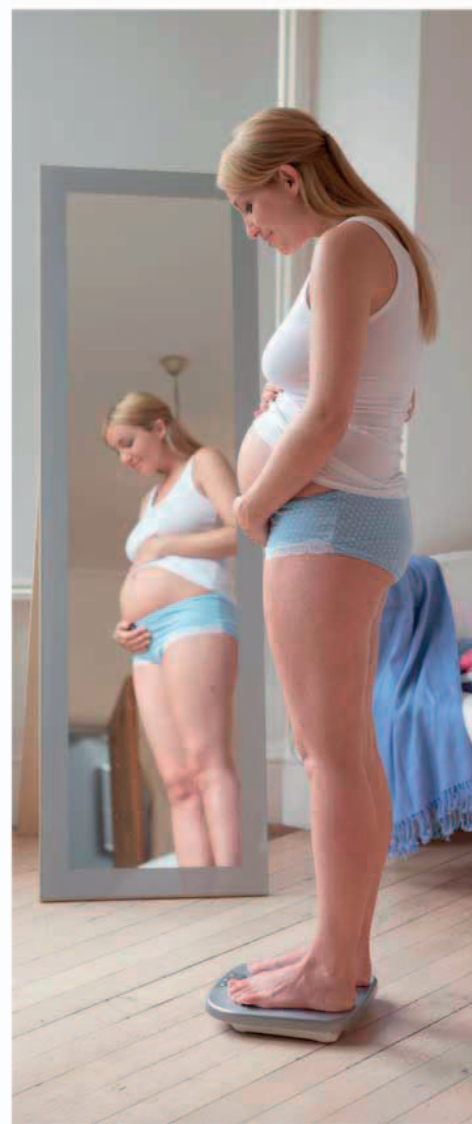
Healthy expectant mothers only need a small proportion of extra calories a day. To ensure optimal health for yourself and your baby, you should expect to increase your calorie intake by

200 calories per day in the first trimester, and by 300 calories per day after that. However, you are burning lots of energy while “building” your baby so it's not surprising that you feel hungry. Follow the advice given in the table (left) to try to stabilize your energy levels, and therefore any food cravings, so that you feel fuller longer. You should also be able to maintain more consistent energy levels if you remember to eat little and often—three meals, with two small (healthy) snacks in between. For quick snacks, try dried fruit with a few nuts, trail mix, rice cakes, oatcakes, or raw vegetable sticks (carrots or broccoli) with hummus, for example. If you feel hungry all the time, try switching to six small meals over the course of the day (see p.58), being careful not to overeat when you do so. Try to remember to check your weight gain at your next checkup (you might need to ask to be weighed, since this doesn't necessarily happen at every appointment) and increase your calorie intake appropriately if your weight is below healthy limits.

Q What can I do to change my eating habits? I want to lose my pregnancy weight after the birth.

Pregnancy, the start of a new life, is a great time to assess poor lifestyle choices and replace them with better ones—particularly when it comes to food. Imagine your plate of food as three separate sections to be filled. Allocate the biggest section of the plate—nearly half—to vegetables, which contain fiber (and so are filling) and are packed with nutrients, but are light on calories. Divide the remainder of your plate evenly between proteins (such as lean meat, fish, and legumes) and unrefined complex carbohydrates (such as potatoes, or brown pasta, or rice). It is a good idea to get your partner onboard with the new eating habits, too—now is a good time to reinforce the notion that you are in this together.

Clean out of your kitchen cupboards as well. Empty them of any refined foods that are high in fat or refined sugar, give the cupboards a thorough cleaning, and replace their contents with healthy alternatives, especially healthy snacks (see p.60). Do the same with your fridge and freezer, so that you are not tempted to indulge in the wrong kinds of food. If you find yourself reaching for a sugary snack, stop, and have a beverage instead: pour yourself a glass



Weight gain You will put on most of your extra weight after 20 weeks of pregnancy. This is mainly due to your growing baby, but you will also be storing fat ready to produce breast milk.

of fruit juice, water, or fruit tea (as long as the tea is safe for pregnancy—see p.53). You could also try making juice ice pops, which last longer and can feel more satisfying than drinking juice.



Did you know...

Unless you are allergic to peanuts yourself, there is no evidence to suggest that eating peanuts while pregnant will contribute to your baby's chances of developing a peanut allergy (including having any impact on asthma or eczema risk). Although high in calories, peanuts are more filling than many other snacks; eat in moderation.